STRATEGIC INTELLIGENCE HUB · MARKET ENTRY ASSESSMENT

Should we launch sustainable trainers online in the UK in 2027?

Fixture workspace · run completed 2026-10-21

RECOMMENDATION · INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE

Run a capped pilot before full entry

Online growth is evidenced [C1]. Margins of 47% are assumed [C42].

Confidence Low (0.23). Weighted evidence coverage 0.25 × penalty 0.90 for 2 high-severity findings. Verdict rule: Less than 35% of the weighted case rests on evidence.

PROCEED ONLY IF

– Measured CAC at or below the assumed 55 by month 4

WHAT WOULD CHANGE THIS

– A survey showing a lower premium

How the score is built

Factor	Weight	Score	Evidence	Basis
Market attractiveness	25%	70	100%	Growth (C1)
Customer demand	20%	50	0%	The analyst gave no assessment. (no claims cited)
Competitive room	15%	50	0%	The analyst gave no assessment. (no claims cited)
Unit economics	25%	50	0%	Guess (no claims cited)
Execution and compliance	15%	50	0%	The analyst gave no assessment. (no claims cited)

Weighted score 55.0 / 100. Factors without evidence are held at 50.

Financial scenarios

	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Break-even month	Not within 36 months	Month 21	Month 7
Payback month	Not within 36 months	Not within 36 months	Month 23
Peak funding need	€679k	€321k	€174k
Revenue, 36 months	€2.22m	€3.11m	€4.33m
Cash at month 36	–€679k	–€219k	€418k

Assumptions

Assumption	Value	Origin
Price per unit	€150	Model estimate
Gross margin	60%	Model estimate
Return rate	30%	Model estimate
Acquisition cost per customer	€55	Model estimate

Assumption	Value	Origin
Marketing per month	€30,000	Model estimate
Repeat purchase rate (12 months)	35%	Model estimate
Fixed costs per month	€15,000	Model estimate
One-off launch cost	€150,000	Model estimate

Most sensitive inputs (change in month-36 cash for a ±20% move): Gross margin –€374k / €374k; Price per unit –€374k / €374k; Acquisition cost per customer €388k / –€259k; Return rate €176k / –€176k

Market and competitors

Competitor	Positioning	Price	Evidence
Northfold	Premium D2C	£150	C14

SWOT

STRENGTHS – Growing online channel (C1)	**WEAKNESSES** – No UK awareness (no evidence)
OPPORTUNITIES – Premium share (C1)	**THREATS** – Price-sensitive buyers (C1)

PESTLE

Factor	Impact	Note	Evidence
Economic	3/5	Growth	C1

Five Forces

Force	Intensity	Rationale	Evidence
Rivalry	3.5/5	Several brands	C14

Critique and missing data

[HIGH] C7: a source of equal or higher tier contradicts this.
[HIGH] C8: no retrieved source states this. Excluded from scoring.
[HIGH] The recommendation text uses figures not found in any claim or assumption: 47%, 55.
[MEDIUM] C11: only blog or user-generated sources support this.
[MEDIUM] The recommendation cites claims that are not usable evidence: C42.
[LOW] C4: rests on a single source; corroborate it.
[LOW] C5: rests on a single source; corroborate it.
[LOW] C6: rests on a single source; corroborate it.
[LOW] C9: rests on a single source; corroborate it.
[LOW] C10: rests on a single source; corroborate it.
[LOW] C11: rests on a single source; corroborate it.
[LOW] C14: rests on a single source; corroborate it.
Missing (High): Customer acquisition cost for UK trainers. Plan: Run a paid pilot

Evidence appendix

Each claim with its status and the extracts the verifier relied on. Relevance shows how closely a passage matched the search; only the support score decides the status.

C1 · Supported · Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by 6.5% in 2025

Entailed by a tier-A source.

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by 6.5% in 2025."

S1 ons.gov.uk · https://www.ons.gov.uk/fixture/footwear-sales · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by about 6.5% in 2025, according to our panel."

S2 retail-analysts.example · https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 0.80

C2 · Supported · Premium trainers accounted for 22% of online footwear spending in 2025

Entailed by a tier-A source.

"Premium trainers accounted for 22% of online footwear spending in 2025."

S1 ons.gov.uk · https://www.ons.gov.uk/fixture/footwear-sales · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

C3 · Supported · Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by about 6.5% in 2025, according to our panel

Entailed by a tier-A source.

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by about 6.5% in 2025, according to our panel."

S2 retail-analysts.example · https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by 6.5% in 2025."

S1 ons.gov.uk · https://www.ons.gov.uk/fixture/footwear-sales · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 0.75

C4 · Partially supported · Competitor Northfold prices its core trainer at £150 and sells direct

Entailed by a single tier-B/C source; needs corroboration.

"Competitor Northfold prices its core trainer at £150 and sells direct."

S2 retail-analysts.example · https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

C5 · Partially supported · The median acceptable premium for sustainable trainers was 10% among UK respondents;

Entailed by a single tier-B/C source; needs corroboration.

"The median acceptable premium for sustainable trainers was 10% among UK respondents;"

S3 survey-institute.example · https://survey-institute.example/fixture/premium · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

C6 · Partially supported · fewer than one in five accepted a premium above 20%

Entailed by a single tier-B/C source; needs corroboration.

"fewer than one in five accepted a premium above 20%."

S3 survey-institute.example · https://survey-institute.example/fixture/premium · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

C7 · Contradicted · Customers will pay a premium of at least 20% for sustainable trainers

Contradicted by 1 passage(s) of equal or higher source tier.

"The median acceptable premium for sustainable trainers was 10%"

S3 survey-institute.example · https://survey-institute.example/fixture/premium · contradicts · support 0.90 · relevance 1.00

"Fixture text for tests. Eco trainers are booming and shoppers love sustainable brands."

S4 lifestyle-blog.medium.com · https://lifestyle-blog.medium.com/fixture/eco-boom · related · support 0.00 · relevance 0.41

"Fixture text for tests. Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by 6.5% in 2025. Premium trainers accounted for 22% of online footwear spending in 2025."

S1 ons.gov.uk · https://www.ons.gov.uk/fixture/footwear-sales · related · support 0.00 · relevance 0.32

C8 · Unsupported · The UK sustainable trainer market will grow 12.4% a year to 2030

Relevant passages were found, but none states this claim. Relevance is not support.

"Fixture text for tests. The median acceptable premium for sustainable trainers was 10% among UK respondents; fewer than one in five accepted a premium above 20%."

S3 survey-institute.example · https://survey-institute.example/fixture/premium · related · support 0.00 · relevance 1.00

"Fixture text for tests. Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by about 6.5% in 2025, according to our panel. Competitor Northfold prices its core trainer at £150 and sells direct."

S2 retail-analysts.example · https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers · related · support 0.00 · relevance 0.59

"Fixture text for tests. Eco trainers are booming and shoppers love sustainable brands."

S4 lifestyle-blog.medium.com · https://lifestyle-blog.medium.com/fixture/eco-boom · related · support 0.00 · relevance 0.47

C9 · Partially supported · The median acceptable premium for sustainable trainers was 10% among UK respondents;

Entailed by a single tier-B/C source; needs corroboration.

"The median acceptable premium for sustainable trainers was 10% among UK respondents;"

S3 survey-institute.example · https://survey-institute.example/fixture/premium · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

C10 · Partially supported · fewer than one in five accepted a premium above 20%

Entailed by a single tier-B/C source; needs corroboration.

"fewer than one in five accepted a premium above 20%."

S3 survey-institute.example · https://survey-institute.example/fixture/premium · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

C11 · Partially supported · Eco trainers are booming and shoppers love sustainable brands

Entailed by a single tier-B/C source; needs corroboration.

"Eco trainers are booming and shoppers love sustainable brands."

S4 lifestyle-blog.medium.com · https://lifestyle-blog.medium.com/fixture/eco-boom · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

C12 · Supported · Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by 6.5% in 2025

Entailed by a tier-A source.

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by 6.5% in 2025."

S1 ons.gov.uk · https://www.ons.gov.uk/fixture/footwear-sales · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by about 6.5% in 2025, according to our panel."

S2 retail-analysts.example · https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 0.80

C13 · Supported · Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by about 6.5% in 2025, according to our panel

Entailed by a tier-A source.

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by about 6.5% in 2025, according to our panel."

S2 retail-analysts.example · https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

"Online footwear sales in the United Kingdom grew by 6.5% in 2025."

S1 ons.gov.uk · https://www.ons.gov.uk/fixture/footwear-sales · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 0.75

C14 · Partially supported · Competitor Northfold prices its core trainer at £150 and sells direct

Entailed by a single tier-B/C source; needs corroboration.

"Competitor Northfold prices its core trainer at £150 and sells direct."

S2 retail-analysts.example · https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers · supports · support 0.88 · relevance 1.00

Sources

Key	Publisher	Tier	Title / location	Retrieved
S1	ons.gov.uk	A	Fixture: footwear retail sales bulletin https://www.ons.gov.uk/fixture/footwear-sales	2026-10-21
S2	retail-analysts.example	B	Fixture: UK trainer market note https://retail-analysts.example/fixture/uk-trainers	2026-10-21
S3	survey-institute.example	B	Fixture: willingness to pay survey https://survey-institute.example/fixture/premium	2026-10-21
S4	lifestyle-blog.medium.com	C	Fixture: eco trainers are booming https://lifestyle-blog.medium.com/fixture/eco-boom	2026-10-21

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